

PARK CROSS-TRAINING SESSIONS

Internal. Started 18 September 2026.

Six 60-minute sessions that need a public park and nothing else. They are calisthenics, agility, plyometric and fencing-footwork work in one hour, broken down to the minute so that a session can be run by whoever turns up first without waiting on a coach to invent it.

These are conditioning sessions, not lessons. They exist because floor time is the club's scarcest resource: when we cannot secure a hall, the physical pillar still has to happen somewhere, and a park is free and always open.

The six sessions

FILE	THEME	BIAS	COST TO THE NERVOUS SYSTEM
01_explosivity.md	Explosivity	Plyometric	High
02_core_and_upper_body.md	Core stability and upper body	Calisthenics	Moderate
03_foot_speed.md	Foot speed	Footwork	High
04_change_of_direction.md	Change of direction and reaction	Agility	High
05_bout_endurance.md	Bout-length repeat effort	Conditioning	Moderate
06_single_leg_control.md	Single-leg strength and landing control	Strength	Low

Every session has the same skeleton, so the shape is familiar even when the content is not:

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warm-up and mobility → activation → three or four work blocks  
→ a fencing-transfer block → a finisher → cool-down
```

Each work block mixes at least two of the four disciplines. That is deliberate: a session that is forty minutes of one thing is a session people stop coming to.

Printing, and reading the bars

Every session exists twice: the .md file is the source, and the .pdf beside it is the sheet to take to the park — A4, black ink on white, three or four pages. Rebuild the PDFs after any edit:

```
python3 tools/workout_pdfs.py          # all of them  
python3 tools/workout_pdfs.py 03      # only names matching "03"
```

The last phrase of every timetable row states that block's pattern — 60 s work / 60 s rest, easy throughout, continuous work, rest — and the PDF turns that phrase into bars: one running across the whole hour, one under every block heading, one inside every timetable row. Solid black is work, gold is warm-up, mobility and cool-down, and white hatching is rest.

The rest is drawn at full size rather than tucked into a footnote because in sessions 1, 3 and 4 the rest is doing as much of the training as the work is. Cutting it to save time turns a speed session into a conditioning session.

Ordering them in a week

Sessions 1, 3 and 4 are the ones that tax the nervous system. Leave at least 48 hours between any two of them, and put them on days when the fencer is fresh — speed work done tired trains slowness. Two workable weeks:

Three days a week	Mon 1 · Wed 3 · Sat 5 Mon 4 · Wed 2 · Sat 6
Four days a week	Mon 1 · Tue 2 · Thu 3 · Sat 6 Mon 4 · Tue 2 · Thu 5 · Sat 6

Session 6 is the lightest and the one to keep when everything else is cut. It is also the one to run the day after a competition.

What the park has to provide

- A flat strip of at least 12 m with no gravel, roots or drainage grates.
- A bench at roughly knee height, sound enough to stand on.
- A bar to hang from. A low bar for inverted rows is a bonus, not a given.
- A post, wall or tree trunk to anchor a band to, carrying some small feature at chest height — a bolt, a knot, the corner of a sign — to aim a point at.

What to bring

Eight cones, a 5 m tape measure, one long resistance band, a jump rope, a phone with a timer and a random-number app, water, and a notebook. A folded towel stands in for a mat. Two full water bottles stand in for weights.

Nothing is marked on the ground. The cones are visual references and nothing else — a start line, a gate to stop inside, a rung to step between, the distance a lunge has to cover — so every session sets up in under a minute and leaves the park exactly as it found it. Where a session needs a measurement, a cone goes down at the landing and the tape does the rest.

Blades, masks and jackets are not needed for any of this. If someone wants to hold a weapon for the point-control work, that is fine, but check the park's posted rules first and never fence — this is footwork, and a park is full of people who did not agree to be in a fencing club.

Rules that are not optional

1. **No flèche on concrete or asphalt.** Ever. If a session offers a flèche, either move that rep onto grass or substitute a balestra-lunge. The flèche is in any case illegal in saber, so saber fencers substitute by default.
2. **Land quietly.** A loud landing is force going through a joint instead of into a muscle. If the landings start getting loud, the power block is over, whatever the plan says.
3. **Stop the block, not the session.** The stop rules in each session are real. Missing a marker is information, not a failure — record it and move to the next block.
4. **Heat.** Taipei summer afternoons are not a training environment. Move to 06:30 or after 18:00 from May to September, drink before you are thirsty, and cut the conditioning blocks first when it is humid.
5. **Under-18s train in sight of a guardian or a second adult**, in line with Part B of docs/minor_safeguarding_consent.txt. That applies in a park exactly as it applies in a hall.
6. **No filming without a signed media release**, including in a public park. See docs/mission_statement.txt.

Scaling

Each session lists an easier and a harder version of its hardest movements. The default rule when a movement is out of reach: keep the tempo, shorten the range. A half-depth split squat done well beats a full one done badly, and a 4-second plank hold repeated eight times beats a 32-second hold that sags at 12.

For fencers under about 14, halve the plyometric contact counts in sessions 1 and 3 and keep the rest as written.

Logging

One line per session in a notebook or a shared sheet, because a training claim we cannot evidence is a training claim we should stop making:

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date · session · who · surface · the marker the session asks for · how it felt 1-10
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The markers are chosen to be measurable with a tape measure and a couple of cones: a jump distance, a rep count inside a fixed time, a left-right difference. Six weeks of those lines is the first real evidence the physical pillar has.